



AI for Lawyers: 5 Things You Can Do in 10 Minutes

Case-law research, drafting, and client communication —
with AI, demo included

GROWT Method

Who Is This Guide For?

This guide is for solo lawyers, legal consultants, mediators, and small-firm practitioners who spend hours on case-law research, draft every document almost from scratch, and struggle to keep client communication consistent. If you want the efficiency of a large firm without its resources, you're in the right place.

What's Inside This Guide?

- Case-law research with AI — 3 hours down to 20 minutes (step-by-step demo)
 - On-demand draft generation — ready document drafts with Claude and ChatGPT prompts
 - Client communication templates — consistent, professional, time-saving
 - A 15-prompt copy-paste pack — written specifically for legal practice
 - 5 AI tools compared — which one to reach for, and when, in legal work
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Three hours a day on case-law research, two on drafting — you can win most of that time back. AI doesn't make the legal call; you do. But it compresses a 3-hour task into 20 minutes. More time for clients, less time on overhead.

Why AI Matters

For legal practices, AI is a step-change in research efficiency. Scanning precedents, reviewing statutes, assessing contract risk — all of it gets dramatically faster with AI-assisted tools. Large international firms accelerated this shift in 2023; for independent lawyers and small firms, the window of opportunity is still wide open.

AI does not make legal decisions — you do. AI gives you the raw research material, draft text, and a framing to work from. Used within ethical bounds, it lets you spend more time with clients, handle more matters, and grow your practice capacity.

The Numbers

23%

Share of a legal team's total time spent on research and document prep — most of which AI can shorten.

Thomson Reuters Legal Technology Survey, 2024

4 hrs

Average time per week lawyers using AI tools save across research and drafting.

Clio Legal Trends Report, 2024

82%

Legal clients who expect faster communication from their lawyer — AI templates close that gap.

LexisNexis Future Ready Lawyer, 2023

WITHOUT AI

- Hours of manual searching in legal databases for relevant precedents
- Finding and re-adapting similar matters from scratch for every draft
- Client update emails rewritten from zero every single time
- Deadlines, document lists, and matter summaries tracked by hand

WITH AI

- You enter the matter and the parties; AI surfaces relevant precedent summaries
- You paste the matter brief; AI produces a draft + argument points
- Client communication templates come back personalized by AI
- Matter summary, deadline calendar, and document list structured in minutes

Scenario 1: Case-Law Research Assistant

Problem:

A new matter lands. You need to analyze the issue, scan relevant precedents, appellate decisions, and current statutes. That's normally a 2-4 hour job requiring deep focus. When several matters stack up, that time becomes critical.

Step-by-Step

- 1 Paste the matter brief into Claude (parties, issue, core claims)
- 2 Use the research prompt below
- 3 Take AI's list of precedents and statutes to investigate
- 4 Verify the key authorities in your jurisdiction's legal database (Westlaw, LexisNexis, etc.)
- 5 Have AI summarize and rank those authorities against your case strategy
- 6 Drop the research summary into your matter notes — work from that draft going forward

EXAMPLE PROMPT

You are an experienced legal research assistant. Based on the matter below, map out the precedents and statutes to research.

Matter details:

- Area of law: [e.g. employment / commercial / family law, etc.]
- Parties: [claimant and respondent positions]
- Core dispute: [explain]
- Relief sought: [damages / annulment / declaratory / other]
- Special circumstances: [add if any]

Please list:

1. Relevant statutory provisions to research (at least 5)
2. Themes of appellate/supreme-court decisions to look up (by topic, 5-7 themes)
3. Argument framework for the claimant (3 core arguments)
4. Likely defenses for the respondent (3 core defenses)
5. Procedural risks to watch for

Note: this research draft will be verified by the lawyer. Not legal advice — a research guide.

BEFORE

**Case-law research: 2-3 hrs,
statute review: 1 hr — 3-4
hrs/matter total**

AFTER

**Research map: 20 minutes,
verifying the key authorities:
30-40 minutes**

Scenario 2: Contract Risk Analysis & Redlining

Problem:

A client brings a new contract — the risks need analyzing before signing. Reading clause by clause takes time. Spotting risky clauses, proposing alternative wording, explaining it to the client in plain language — each is its own task.

Step-by-Step

- 1 Paste the contract into Claude (or upload the PDF — Claude Pro supports it)
- 2 Use the risk-analysis prompt
- 3 Review the risky clauses AI flags
- 4 Ask AI for alternative wording for each risk
- 5 Have it prepare a plain-language summary for the client
- 6 Do your final review, send for signature

EXAMPLE PROMPT

Review the contract below from a legal risk-analysis perspective. Client: the buyer / tenant / service-recipient party.

Contract text:

[Paste the contract text here]

Please:

1. List clauses that could work against the client (clause number and a short note)
2. Propose a balanced, alternative wording for each risky clause
3. Flag any important protective clauses you think are missing
4. Assess the contract's overall risk profile (Low / Medium / High)
5. Write a 5-point plain-language summary for the client (no jargon)

Note: this analysis will be reviewed by the lawyer. Not legal advice — a preliminary draft.

BEFORE

**Manual reading and analysis:
2-3 hrs, client summary: 30-45
minutes**

AFTER

**AI pre-analysis: 15-20 min-
utes, lawyer review and redline:
30-40 minutes**

Scenario 3: Client Communication Automation

Problem:

A hearing date is set and the client needs to know. You want to send a status update. You need to prepare a document checklist. Writing each from scratch eats time and produces inconsistent results — the same information explained differently to different clients.

Step-by-Step

- 1 Gather the client and matter details
- 2 Use the communication prompt below
- 3 Copy AI's output, personalize it
- 4 Paste into your email client, send
- 5 Save the templates you use often — next time will be faster

EXAMPLE PROMPT

Prepare a client-update package from the details below.

Client name: [Full name]

Matter: [short description]

Latest development: [what happened?]

Hearing/meeting date: [date/time/place]

What the client needs to bring: [document list]

Estimated remaining timeline: [info]

Please produce:

1. An update email (professional, warm, clear — minimal jargon)
2. A hearing-prep checklist (for the client, step by step)
3. A WhatsApp reminder message (for 2 days before the hearing, short)
4. A document list (itemized, with a short note on why each is needed)

All text in English, professional but accessible.

BEFORE

15-20 minutes per client message, inconsistency across matters

AFTER

Template generation: 5-10 minutes, personalization: 5 minutes — standard and fast

Recommended AI Tools

Claude (claude.ai)

Free

The most capable AI assistant for long-document analysis, contract review, and professional correspondence — with PDF upload support.

Best for: [Contract analysis](#), [document drafts](#), [client letters](#)

ChatGPT (chatgpt.com)

Free

A strong complement for research mapping, argument framing, and alternative legal approaches.

Best for: [Research mapping](#), [argument development](#), [FAQ prep](#)

Notion AI (notion.so)

Paid

AI-assisted note-taking and knowledge management for matter notes, hearing prep, and document organization.

Best for: [Matter tracking](#), [research notes](#), [client portfolio management](#)

Calendly (calendly.com)

Free

Online scheduling that automates client consultation bookings and sends reminder emails.

Best for: [Client booking automation](#), [first-consultation coordination](#)

Westlaw / LexisNexis

Paid

Your jurisdiction's case-law and statute databases — verify every AI research output against these primary sources.

Best for: [Precedent verification](#), [statute tracking](#), [current decision research](#)

Copy-Paste Prompt Pack

1. Case-Law Research Map

Map out the precedents and statutes to research for this matter. Area of law: [area]. Core dispute: [issue]. I want: statutory provisions to research (at least 5), appellate decision themes (5-7 topics), an argument framework for both sides. Note: a preliminary draft to be verified by the lawyer.

Expected output: A structured research map, statute list, and theme list

2. Document Draft

Draft a [document type] from the details below. Claimant: [info]. Respondent: [info]. Relief sought: [relief]. Core arguments: [arguments]. Evidence to attach: [list]. Use formal language appropriate to my jurisdiction. Final review is the lawyer's.

Expected output: A draft in standard document format

3. Contract Risk Analysis

Review this contract for risks against my client: [text]. List risky clauses, propose alternative wording for each, give an overall risk profile (Low/Medium/High), and write a 5-point plain-language summary for the client.

Expected output: Risky-clause list, alternative wordings, client summary

4. Client Update Email

Write a client update email to [Name] about their matter. Matter: [subject]. Latest development: [development]. Next step: [step]. Date: [date]. Tone: professional, clear, warm. Minimal jargon. In English.

Expected output: A ready-to-send client update email

5. Hearing Prep Notes

Prepare a hearing-prep summary for a [matter type]. Matter summary: [summary]. Strategy: [strategy]. Expected counter-arguments: [list]. Please give: core arguments (itemized), ready answers to likely questions, the order to present evidence, and a timing suggestion.

Expected output: A structured hearing-prep note

6. Statute Summary

Write a short, clear summary of [statute name / section number]. Include: the gist (2-3 sentences), who it affects, what it means in practice, and any recent updates or changes (if you know them). Plain language a client could read.

Expected output: A client-readable statute summary

7. Legal Risk Report

Write a short legal risk report for [client name] on [subject]. Include: current-situation assessment, legal risks (high/medium/low), recommended measures, and time-sensitive items. One page, itemized.

Expected output: A one-page legal risk summary report

8. Client FAQ Document

Prepare the 10 most common client questions and answers about [matter type]. Tone: clear, calm, reassuring. Explain any technical terms in parentheses. I'll put this on my website or send it to clients.

Expected output: A 10-question client FAQ, ready for website or email

9. Matter Summary Note

Build a structured matter-summary note from these raw details: [details]. The summary should include: parties and their relationship, the core dispute, what's been done so far, pending steps, and critical dates/deadlines. Short and clear.

Expected output: A structured matter-summary note, ready for the file

10. Engagement Scope Letter

Write a formal engagement / scope letter to [Name] about [subject]. The letter should include: a summary of the matter, its legal posture, the proposed action plan, the client's responsibilities, and my contact details. Formal format, in English, starting with "Dear [Name]".

Expected output: A formal client engagement letter

11. Hearing Reminder

Write a hearing reminder for client [Name]. Date: [date]. Time: [time]. Court/place: [place]. What to bring: [list]. For WhatsApp: short, clear, friendly but professional. Max 100 words.

Expected output: A WhatsApp-ready hearing reminder

12. Authority / Mandate Scope Check

Review the engagement / authority text below and assess: is the scope sufficient?, are any powers missing?, are there limits for special situations?, are additional authority clauses needed? [Authority text: text]

Expected output: A scope assessment and missing-authority list

13. Deadline Tracker Summary

List the critical limitation periods and deadlines for a [matter type]. For each: how long it runs, how the start date is calculated, and any exceptions. Practical reminder: these must be verified against the statute by the lawyer.

Expected output: A critical-deadline list with a calculation guide

14. Demand Letter Draft

Draft a demand letter for this situation. Sender: [info]. Recipient: [info]. Subject of demand: [subject]. What's demanded: [demand]. Deadline: [days]. Use formal legal language in English. A draft for lawyer approval.

Expected output: A formal demand-letter draft

15. Settlement Prep Summary

Prepare a summary for a settlement negotiation. Matter: [info]. Client position: [position]. Likely counter-offer: [estimate]. Please give: acceptable minimum terms, a negotiation framework, the upsides and risks of settling, and next steps if rejected.

Expected output: A settlement-negotiation strategy summary

16. Client Information Letter

Write a formal information letter to [Name] about [subject]. Include: a summary of the issue, its legal status, the recommended action plan, the client's responsibilities, and my contact information. Formal format, starting with "Dear [Name]".

Expected output: A formal client information letter

Your First 7 Days

One step a day. By the end of the week, you'll have seen your first results.

- ☐ Day 1: Sign up for Claude.ai. Test the research map prompt (Prompt 1) on an active matter. Verify the output in your legal database.
- ☐ Day 2: Generate a draft for one of your common document types with Prompt 2. Compare it to your own draft — which parts are usable?
- ☐ Day 3: Build a client communication template library: use Prompt 4 and Prompt 10 to produce 5 templates. Save them in Notion or Word.
- ☐ Day 4: Open a Calendly account, create a client first-consultation page. Set up the auto-confirmation and reminder email.
- ☐ Day 5: Test Prompt 3 on an existing contract or document. Compare AI's analysis with your own assessment.
- ☐ Day 6: If you don't have one, generate content for an FAQ page with Prompt 7. Add it to your client waiting area or emails.
- ☐ Day 7: Review the week's results: which prompts saved you the most time? Build and save your own prompt library.

Transform with the GROWT Method

Applying what you've seen in this guide is the G stage of the GROWT Method — recognizing your current processes and seeing where AI can make a difference. In the next stage (Roadmap), we plan the AI setup specific to your practice: which processes return the most when automated first, and how to strengthen your digital presence to win new clients. Take the quiz to see your personal plan.

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- G** — Gap Analysis
 - R** — Roadmap
 - O** — Operationalize
 - W** — Win
 - T** — Transform

This guide gave you a starting point. With the GROWT Method's structured process, complete the full transformation across 5 levels.

growtify.ai/test → **Build your plan**

Next step: Get the AI Roadmap for Your Practice

Every legal practice has different priorities. Where's the fastest win for yours? Which tools should you set up first? To find out, take the free AI Digital Maturity Test at growtify.ai/test. The 5-minute quiz produces a personal roadmap for your firm and your practice.

Build Your Plan →

growtify.ai/test